

Day 64 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Economy (2): Manufacturing, FTAs & Investment

READING MATERIAL

Covers India's Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme results, the new National Mission on Manufacturing, recent trade negotiations, and a major private AI infrastructure investment.

Q: What is the PLI (Production-Linked Incentive) Scheme's total outlay, and what had it achieved as of December 2025?

A: Total outlay: ₹1,97,000 crore (~USD 22.9 billion). As of December 2025, it had generated investments exceeding ₹2.16 lakh crore, driven incremental production of over ₹20.41 lakh crore, and created over 14.39 lakh jobs.

Q: What is the National Mission on Manufacturing (NMM), and what are its targets?

A: Announced in Budget 2025-26, it aims to raise manufacturing's share of GDP to 25% by 2035, create 143 million jobs, and expand merchandise exports to ₹106.05 lakh crore (about USD 1.20 trillion).

Q: What did the India-US interim trade agreement achieve regarding tariffs?

A: It reduced US tariffs on Indian goods to 18%, with improved access across sectors like textiles, agriculture, technology, and manufacturing.

Q: When did India and Israel begin negotiations for a proposed Free Trade Agreement (FTA), and where?

A: 24 February 2026, in New Delhi — the first round of talks, covering sectors like technology, AI, cybersecurity, manufacturing, agriculture, and services.

Q: What major AI infrastructure investment was announced in October 2025, and by whom?

A: Bharti Airtel and Google established India's first Artificial Intelligence hub, in Visakhapatnam, on 14 October 2025 — with a proposed investment of around ₹1,25,000 crore (~USD 15 billion) over 2026-2030, covering data centres, subsea cable connectivity, and clean-energy-supported digital infrastructure.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The PLI (Production-Linked Incentive) Scheme has a total outlay of approximately:

- A. ₹50,000 crore
- B. ₹1,00,000 crore
- C. ₹1,97,000 crore ✓**
- D. ₹3,50,000 crore

Explanation: ₹1,97,000 crore. [medium, web-research]

2. As of December 2025, the PLI Scheme had created approximately how many jobs?

- A. 5 lakh
- B. 10 lakh
- C. 14.39 lakh ✓**
- D. 25 lakh

Explanation: 14.39 lakh jobs. [hard, web-research]

3. The National Mission on Manufacturing (NMM), announced in Budget 2025-26, targets raising manufacturing's GDP share to 25% by:

- A. 2028
- B. 2030
- C. 2032
- D. 2035 ✓**

Explanation: 2035. [medium, web-research]

4. The India-US interim trade agreement reduced US tariffs on Indian goods to:

- A. 10%
- B. 15%
- C. 18% ✓**

D. 25%

Explanation: 18%. [medium, web-research]

5. India and Israel began negotiations for a proposed FTA on 24 February 2026, in which city?

A. Tel Aviv

B. Mumbai

C. New Delhi ✓

D. Jerusalem

Explanation: New Delhi. [medium, web-research]

6. Bharti Airtel and Google established India's first AI hub (October 2025) in which city?

A. Bengaluru

B. Hyderabad

C. Visakhapatnam ✓

D. Chennai

Explanation: Visakhapatnam. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Number Series

READING MATERIAL

Number Series is the final Reasoning skill. Real exam evidence shows 6 distinct underlying patterns: second-difference (difference-of-differences) sequences, sum-of-consecutive-cubes, geometric progression, arithmetic progression, n^2 multiples, and prime-number-squared sequences — recognize the pattern TYPE before trying to compute term-by-term.

Q: Method — sum of consecutive cubes: Find the next term: 9, 35, 91, ?

A: Each term is $n^3 + (n+1)^3$: $1^3 + 2^3 = 1 + 8 = 9$ ✓, $2^3 + 3^3 = 8 + 27 = 35$ ✓, $3^3 + 4^3 = 27 + 64 = 91$ ✓. Next: $4^3 + 5^3 = 64 + 125 = 189$.

Q: Method — second-difference (arithmetic sequence of differences): Fill in the blank: 1, 6, 15, 28, 45, ____, 91.

A: Differences: $6 - 1 = 5$, $15 - 6 = 9$, $28 - 15 = 13$, $45 - 28 = 17$ — these differences themselves increase by 4 each time. Next difference = $17 + 4 = 21$, so the blank = $45 + 21 = 66$. (Check: $91 - 66 = 25 = 21 + 4$ ✓ consistent.)

Q: Method — sequence of squared primes: Find the missing number in the sequence of squared prime numbers: 4 (2^2), 9 (3^2), 25 (5^2), 49 (7^2), ?, 169 (13^2).

A: The base numbers are consecutive primes: 2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13. The missing term corresponds to $11^2 = 121$. (Caution: the original source rendered this sequence with garbled formatting that looked like plain 3-digit numbers rather than squared primes — always re-derive the actual pattern rather than trusting a confusing transcription.)

Q: Method — simple arithmetic progression (AP) with increasing-by-2 differences: Find the next term: 1, 5, 11, 19, 29, ?

A: Differences: 4, 6, 8, 10 — increasing by 2 each time. Next difference = 12, so next term = $29 + 12 = 41$.

Q: Method — geometric progression (GP): Find the 8th term of 2, 6, 18, 54, ...

A: Common ratio = 3 (each term $\times 3$). Terms: 2, 6, 18, 54, 162, 486, 1458, 4374. The 8th term is 4,374.

Q: Method — plain arithmetic progression, nth term formula: Find the 20th term of 7, 10, 13, ...

A: First term = 7, common difference = 3. nth term = $a + (n-1)d = 7 + (19 \times 3) = 7 + 57 = 64$.

Q: Method — multiples of n^2 : Find the missing number: 3, 12, 27, 48, 75, 108, ____.

A: Each term = $3 \times n^2$ for $n=1, 2, 3, \dots$: $3 \times 1 = 3$, $3 \times 4 = 12$, $3 \times 9 = 27$, $3 \times 16 = 48$, $3 \times 25 = 75$, $3 \times 36 = 108$. Next ($n=7$): $3 \times 49 = 147$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the next term: 2, 9, 28, 65, 126, ?

A. 215

B. 217 ✓

C. 219

D. 221

Explanation: Each term is $n^3 + 1$: $1^3 + 1 = 2$, $2^3 + 1 = 9$, $3^3 + 1 = 28$, $4^3 + 1 = 65$, $5^3 + 1 = 126$. Next: $6^3 + 1 = 216 + 1 = 217$. [hard, authored]

2. Fill in the blank: 2, 7, 14, 23, 34, ____, 62.

A. 45

B. 47 ✓

C. 49

D. 51

Explanation: Differences: 5, 7, 9, 11 — increasing by 2. Next difference = 13, so blank = $34 + 13 = 47$. (Check: $62 - 47 = 15 = 13 + 2$, consistent.) [medium, authored]

3. Find the next term: 3, 7, 15, 27, 43, ?

A. 61

B. 63 ✓

C. 65

D. 67

Explanation: Differences: 4, 8, 12, 16 — increasing by 4. Next difference = 20, so next term = $43 + 20 = 63$. [medium, authored]

4. Find the 7th term of the GP: 3, 9, 27, 81, ...

A. 1,458

B. 2,187 ✓

C. 2,287

D. 1,987

Explanation: Common ratio 3: 3,9,27,81,243,729,2187. 7th term = 2,187. [medium, authored]

5. Find the 15th term of the AP: 5, 9, 13, 17, ...

A. 59

B. 61 ✓

C. 63

D. 65

Explanation: $a=5$, $d=4$. 15th term = $5+(14 \times 4) = 5+56 = 61$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the missing number: 2, 8, 18, 32, 50, ____.

A. 62

B. 68

C. 72 ✓

D. 78

Explanation: Each term = $2 \times n^2$: $2 \times 1=2$, $2 \times 4=8$, $2 \times 9=18$, $2 \times 16=32$, $2 \times 25=50$. Next ($n=6$): $2 \times 36=72$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Vocabulary: Figures of Speech

READING MATERIAL

Covers the most commonly tested figures of speech via real exam example sentences — simile, metaphor, imagery, alliteration, repetition vs. anaphora, and allusion.

Q: What is the key difference between a SIMILE and a METAPHOR, and what are some real exam examples of each?

A: A SIMILE compares two things explicitly using 'like', 'as', or 'than' (e.g., "Life is like a pathless wood"; "run as fast as the wind"; "faster than a cheetah... bigger than a mountain"; "the bus is slow as a snail"). A METAPHOR compares two things DIRECTLY, without 'like/as' (e.g., "His words are pearls of wisdom" — his words ARE described as pearls, not 'like' pearls).

Q: Real exam: "That hears the sweetest music and finds the finest mirth" — which figure of speech is this?

A: IMAGERY — vivid, sensory descriptive language that creates a mental picture/sensation for the reader, without necessarily being a direct comparison (simile/metaphor).

Q: What is the difference between REPETITION and ANAPHORA, with real exam examples?

A: REPETITION is simply repeating a word or phrase anywhere in a passage for emphasis (e.g., "'Oh, no, no,' said the little fly" — repeating 'no'). ANAPHORA is the more SPECIFIC repetition of a word/phrase at the START of successive clauses or lines (a particular, structured type of repetition).

Q: Real exam: "And I Sunned it with smiles" — identify the alliteration in this line.

A: "Sunned — smile" — both words begin with the same 's' consonant SOUND (alliteration is about repeated initial SOUNDS, not just letters).

Q: What is an ALLUSION, and what type is used in "On the day of Sicilian July, with Etna Smoking"?

A: An allusion is a brief reference to a real person, place, event, or work, without explicitly explaining it — assuming the reader will recognise it. "Etna Smoking" refers to Mount Etna, a real active volcano in Sicily — confirmed as a GEOGRAPHICAL allusion by a real exam question (as opposed to cultural, biblical, or political allusions).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Life is compared to a pathless wood with the word 'like'." What figure of speech is this?

- A. Metaphor
- B. Simile ✓**
- C. Personification
- D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Simile. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. Which of the following is a METAPHOR (not a simile)?

- A. Life is like a chocolate box
- B. Raj is like his twin brother
- C. His words are pearls of wisdom ✓**
- D. The bus is slow as a snail

Explanation: "His words are pearls of wisdom" — direct comparison, no like/as. [medium, question-bank-2024]

3. "To win, run as fast as the wind." Identify the figure of speech.

- A. Personification
- B. Metaphor
- C. Simile ✓**
- D. Anaphora

Explanation: Simile ("as fast as"). [easy, question-bank-2024]

4. "That hears the sweetest music and finds the finest mirth." Identify the figure of speech.

- A. Metaphor
- B. Personification
- C. Imagery ✓**
- D. Onomatopoeia

Explanation: Imagery. [medium, question-bank-2022]

5. "Oh, no, no, no," said the little fly." What figure of speech is here?

- A. Assonance
- B. Alliteration
- C. Anaphora

D. Repetition ✓

Explanation: Repetition. [medium, question-bank-2022]

6. "And I Sunned it with smiles." Identify the alliteration in the line.

- A. I — it

B. Sunned — smiles ✓

- C. And — with
- D. Sunned — with

Explanation: Sunned — smiles. [hard, question-bank-2024]

7. "On the day of Sicilian July, with Etna Smoking." What type of allusion is used here?

- A. Cultural allusion
- B. Biblical allusion

C. Geographical allusion ✓

- D. Political allusion

Explanation: Geographical allusion (Mount Etna, Sicily). [hard, question-bank-2017]

8. "Faster than a cheetah, with a tail that's miles long, bigger than a mountain, so powerful and strong." Identify the figure of speech.

- A. Imagery
- B. Anaphora
- C. Consonance

D. Simile ✓

Explanation: Simile (comparative 'than'). [medium, question-bank-2025]